

North Georgia Approved Stream Mitigation Banks Database

Regional Project Registry, Watershed Basin Service Areas, & RIBITS Portal Guide

This document establishes a comprehensive reference database of approved stream mitigation banks operating within the river basins of North Georgia (Coosa, Etowah, Upper Chattahoochee, and Toccoa/Ocoee basins). It provides Hunter with real-world project precedents, bank sponsor contacts, and step-by-step instructions to access the official federal **RIBITS** database for live credit availability and pricing intelligence.

1. Official Federal Database Portal: USACE RIBITS

The U.S. Army Corps of Engineers maintains the official national registry of all approved mitigation banks, in-lieu fee programs, and credit ledgers:

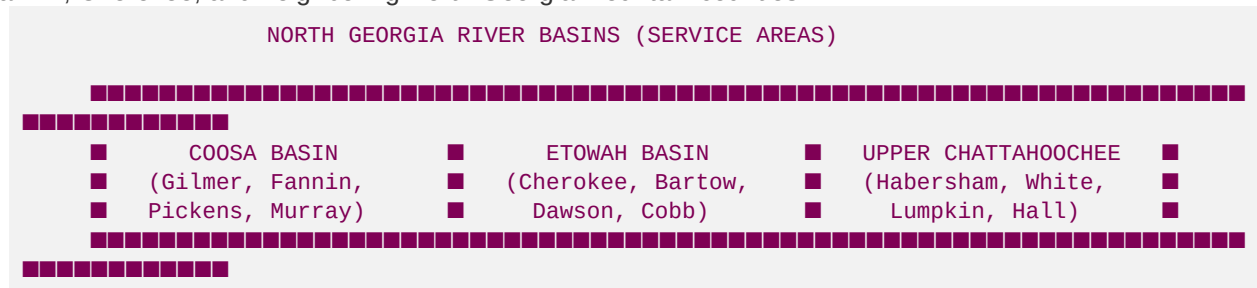
- **Official Database Link:** [USACE RIBITS Portal (<https://ribits.ops.usace.army.mil/>)](<https://ribits.ops.usace.army.mil/>)
- **Purpose:** Track active banks, credit types (stream vs. wetland), approved service area maps, credit transaction ledgers, and official **Mitigation Banking Instruments (MBIs)**.

Step-by-Step Guide for Hunter to Navigate RIBITS:

1. **Access the Portal:** Open the RIBITS home page. On the left-hand navigation panel under **"Filter View"**, select **"Savannah"** from the USACE District dropdown menu. (The Savannah District holds regulatory jurisdiction over all of Georgia).
 2. **View District Banks:** Click on **"Mitigation Banks"** under the district menu. This will display an alphabetical list of all approved, pending, and sold-out commercial banks in Georgia.
 3. **Filter by Watershed/Basin:** To find competitors or projects near Anderson Creek or Noontootla Creek, filter the view using the **"Service Area"** tab. Select your target **Hydrologic Unit Code (HUC)** or river basin (e.g., Coosa HUC 031501, Upper Chattahoochee HUC 031300, Etowah HUC 03150104).
 4. **Audit the Credit Ledger:** Click on any active bank name, and select the **"Ledger"** tab. This shows exactly:
 - *Total Credits Released* to date.
 - *Total Credits Sold* (with transaction dates and corresponding USACE permit numbers).
 - *Remaining Credit Balance* available for sale.
 5. **Examine the MBI Document:** Under the **"Cyber Repository"** tab for the selected bank, download the approved **Mitigation Banking Instrument (MBI)**. This contains the exact geomorphic plans, construction drawings, native planting lists, and monitoring performance standards that the Corps approved for that specific project.
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2. Registry of Approved North Georgia Stream Mitigation Banks

Mitigation banks do not operate by county lines; they are approved to sell credits within specific **River Basins (Service Areas)**. The following registry documents the primary approved stream banks covering Gilmer, Fannin, Cherokee, and neighboring North Georgia mountain counties:



A. Coosa River Basin (Primary Basin for Anderson Creek / ACR)

- **Bank Name:** Upper Coosa River Mitigation Bank
- **Status:** Approved / Active
- **Primary Location:** Gilmer & Pickens Counties, GA
- **River Basin (HUC):** Coosa River Basin (HUC 031501)
- **Sponsor / Operator:** Regional Ecological Investors / Broker Networks
- **Service Area:** Gilmer, Fannin, Pickens, Murray, and Gordon counties.
- **Restoration Design:** Priority 1 geomorphic valley reconnection and Priority 2 natural channel design utilizing boulder cross-vanes and soft-grading bioengineering.
- **Bank Name:** Legacy Farms Stream Mitigation Bank
- **Status:** Approved / Active (Zebra-striped release phase)
- **Primary Location:** Pickens County, GA
- **River Basin (HUC):** Coosa River Basin (HUC 031501)
- **Sponsor / Operator:** Developed by **The Wetlandsbank Company (TWC)**
- **Service Area:** Primary service area covers the Upper Coosa watershed.
- **Restoration Design:** Large-scale agricultural flood-plain reconnection, meandering channel construction, and 100-foot native hardwood riparian planting.

B. Etowah River Basin (Primary Basin for Cherokee County / Metro North)

- **Bank Name:** Cochrans Creek Stream Mitigation Bank
- **Status:** Approved / Active
- **Primary Location:** Dawson & Cherokee Counties, GA
- **River Basin (HUC):** Etowah River Basin (HUC 03150104)
- **Sponsor / Operator:** Corblu Ecology Group / Broker Partners
- **Service Area:** Cherokee, Dawson, Forsyth, Pickens, and Bartow counties.
- **Restoration Design:** Steep mountain tributary stabilization using natural log step-pools, bank wrapping, and native hemlock/rhododendron planting.

- **Bank Name:** Good Neighbor Creek Mitigation Bank
 - *Status:* Approved / Sold Out (Closed ledger, historical reference)
 - *Primary Location:* Cherokee County, GA
 - *River Basin (HUC):* Etowah River Basin (HUC 03150104)
 - *Sponsor / Operator:* Environmental Land Assets
 - *Service Area:* Cherokee, Cobb, and Bartow counties.
 - *Restoration Design:* Channel stabilization and riparian buffer enhancement on degraded agricultural pasture land.
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C. Upper Chattahoochee River Basin (Primary Northeast Basin)

- **Bank Name:** Demorest Lake Stream Mitigation Bank
 - *Status:* Approved / Active
 - *Primary Location:* Habersham County, GA
 - *River Basin (HUC):* Upper Chattahoochee Basin (HUC 03130001)
 - *Sponsor / Operator:* Resource Environmental Solutions (RES)
 - *Service Area:* Habersham, White, Lumpkin, Hall, and Stephens counties.
 - *Restoration Design:* Full-delivery geomorphic stream and wetland restoration. Reconnected old agricultural channels to native floodplains and installed extensive woody debris structures.
 - **Bank Name:** Southern Cross Ranch Mitigation Bank
 - *Status:* Approved / Active
 - *Primary Location:* Lumpkin County, GA
 - *River Basin (HUC):* Upper Chattahoochee Basin (HUC 03130001)
 - *Sponsor / Operator:* Private Bank Sponsor / Mitigation Resource Group
 - *Service Area:* Lumpkin, Dawson, Hall, and White counties.
 - *Restoration Design:* Rosgen Priority 1 meandering channel restoration in highly eroded mountain valley pastures, featuring native boulder J-hooks and root wad bank protection.
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3. Secondary Reference Database: Georgia LandCAN

While RIBITS is the official USACE regulatory tracking system, the **Georgia Land Conservation Assistance Network (LandCAN)** serves as a vital secondary reference:

- **Link:** [Georgia LandCAN Mitigation Directory (<https://georgialandcan.org/>)](<https://georgialandcan.org/>)
- **How Hunter Can Use It:**
 - **Sponsor Directory:** LandCAN maintains an active, public directory of individual bank sponsors, ecological engineering firms, land trusts, and environmental attorneys active in North Georgia.
 - **Landowner Resources:** Provides specialized guides for private landowners who are interested in conserving their land, establishing restrictive covenants, or setting up a conservation easement to generate tax credits alongside mitigation credits.

- **Network Outreach:** Hunter can use the LandCAN sponsor lists to directly identify regional landowners who have already expressed interest in conservation, serving as prime prospects for direct stream restoration pitches.